UAC Newsletter

September 2026



UAC Team, Perisher Cup – Championed by Ned Dale, Talia Davis

Board Members

Chairperson – David Stuart Secretary – Bill Russell Treasurer – Stewart Smith
Membership – Lesley Neilson Ordinary Directors – Talia Davis, Ned Dale & John Lembke

From your Board

Activities with your Board have continued in earnest over the winter to focus on seeking lease clarification, constitution review, background processes which included the automated booking system & locking in the 75th anniversary dinner for 15th May.
Sub-committees also formed to report to the Board, namely:

Lease correspondence – John Lembke & David Smith.
Constitution Review – John Lembke, John Russell Jnr & Felicity Russell.
Governance Review – David Stuart & Ken Davis.
Strategic/Master Plan – John Lembke, Pearce Cohen, Ken Davis & Julia Wright.
Anniversary dinner – Lesley Neilson, Amy Lembke, Sophie Mulhuish & Jack Burge.
Building committee – David Stuart, Ned Dale, Richard Dale & Chuck Fritchley.
House Committee – Talia Davis, Maureen Lembke, Lesley Neilson, Sue Fritchley & Anna Davis.
Environment Committee – David Stuart, Russell Copeman, Sophie Mulhuish & Jack Burge.
IT/Webmaster – Ned Dale & Talia Davis.

LODGE OPERATIONS

Lease

Over July & August, correspondence with the Parks was undertaken with a view to opening discussions for lease renewal options. Correspondence to date from the NPWS indicate that the current terms of our lease will remain unchanged and any liaison from the Parks will be in due course after the current review of other lodges in the Valley has been completed. Our representation has been ongoing with SLOPES, as they will continue to raise matters for the Valley lodges generally.

Bookings

Winter bookings were very healthy despite the poor conditions, though vacancies have increased from early September. With initial teething problems being minimal, the calendar has been opened up to the end of February 2027 for summer bookings. Remember if any issues please contact the booking manager - Paul Thompson, bookings@uac.net.au

Anniversary Celebration, 2027 – 75 years

Arranging a venue was a top priority due to the high demand on city locations. Lesley Neilson reviewed and presented a number of options with commitment now made for an evening dinner at Park Royal Darling Harbour on Saturday the 15th May. Please diarise the date, as more information will be forthcoming over the following months.

Any members, who wish to be part of the organisation team, big or small, please contact membership, Lesley – membership@uac.net.au

Work Party's – Building & House

The first work party has been set for the week-end of 31 Oct – 1 November.

Priority will be for younger members who need to undertake a work party as part of their obligation for full membership, however, this should not discourage others who would wish to attend.

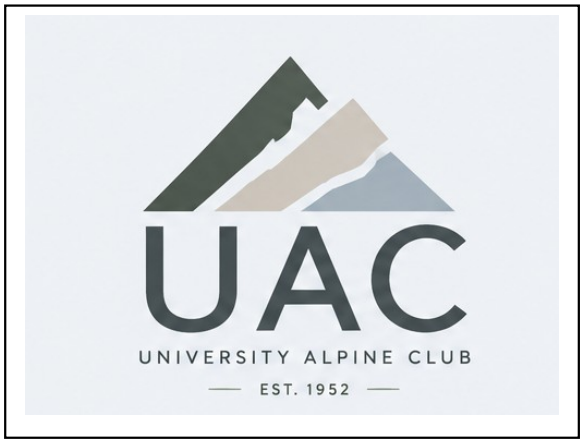
Please contact David Stuart, who is convening – email, dstuart@colormaker.com.au

Note, there will be another building work party in February/March with a House work party in April to re-stock & ready the lodge for the incoming winter. Dates for these will be advised in early 2027.

Logo ideas for UAC

The Board has considered that a club logo is overdue to enhance a sense of belonging and participation as a club. With our 75th anniversary on the horizon, it is considered that this is the ideal occasion to canvas members for their ideas.

During the season, some concepts were canvased at the lodge over dinner and with some continued conversation over wine in front of the fire. The various outcomes have been consolidated into the two below, which are intended to provide stimulus for further conversation by members to submit ideas for Board consideration. It is requested that whilst the option of AI could be appealing to many the utilisation of original thinking is encouraged.





Please email your preferred design before 10 October, less than 1.5Mb, to news@uac.net.au

Sub-Committee reports

Briefing of the Sub-Committees is undertaken by your Board specifying the required parameters &/or outcomes. As these are received and considered, ideas to be implemented will be canvased/advised to the membership.

Valley and Area News

Perisher Cup

Whilst the snow depth this year has been questionable at best, it has not dampened the spirits across the Valley. Crowds were ever present during the core periods of July/August with just the shoulder periods suffering the most with little or no coverage and for most resorts necessitating an early closure.

Despite all that El Nino can deliver, Perisher Vail has done an amazing job to keep trails open & lifts operating. Importantly for us at UAC, the Perisher Cup was highlighted as the annual major event, held on 12 September under crystal blue skies.

The inaugural Perisher Cup was donated by Kosciusko Snow Revellers Club (KSRC) in 1953 for perpetual friendly competition between Perisher lodges. The first event was held on the long weekend in 1953 with the four clubs, namely ourselves – UAC, Cooma, Telemark & KSRC. The event consists of teams of four members competing in GS, jump and cross-country relay. UAC did win the cup in 1968 and is positioned on the fire mantle place – most of us probably thought it was just an old drinking mug but alas, it holds many stories.

This year Ned & Talia headed our team, photo on the front of this newsletter, with support from other associate members. They represented our club in the spirit of the event and despite other lodges having multiple teams they secured a very worthy 5th place out of the 13 competing – well done.

News roundup from across the region

Local magazines and SLOPES provide a great coverage of events and happenings in the broader region of Monaro Shire. Particular items that may interest our members are:

- Snow making explained. The details and developments across the industry. Fascinating reading on the new web site at – “snowissnow”.
- Warmer temperatures in the area with all things unseasonal. Even humorous sidelines such as “Perisher Marina” and “Alp lakes”.
- Thredbo write down from $m292 to $m143 with possible sale by EVT so they can focus on the hotel industry as their core business.
- Thredbo new $m35 6-seater chair to replace the 1988 Gunbarrel lift, for operation by 2027.
- “WildBrumby” distillery, our very own favourite home of local schnapps, has been sold but will continue to operate and grow across the region. Drop in and introduce yourself to the new owners.

SLOPES

The news from SLOPES continues to be prolific over the past months. Item of major interest to all is the Lease renewal. For the latest, please catch up with happenings by using the link on the club web site. STOP PRESS – Perisher expected to close 25 September – check the latest SLOPES newsletter & Perisher site for more details.

From the News Desk

Positions vacant.

1. Contributing articles are always welcome, either of your own adventures or of a favourite resort.
2. Facebook & Instagram are just two of the social medias that we as UAC need to consider. If you have a good understanding of what might be best suited for UAC and are able to implement and/or administer, please make contact with any of the Board members to discuss further.

Remember all contributions welcome by the 15th of the publishing month – news@uac.net.au .